Word Hoard

Accepted words and phrases for advanced learners of English

1 entries · updated 04 October 2026

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portend 3

Words

portend

POR-tend /ˈpɔː.tɛnd/

to be a sign or warning of something about to happen

MEANINGS

1. **verb** To be a sign or warning that something, especially something unpleasant, will happen.

EXAMPLES

The scale of Meta’s reshaping is staggering, though, and may portend what’s to come across all of tech; we have not seen a tech giant cut up to a fifth of its workforce to offset just how massive its AI spending has become.

— The Guardian, 24 Mar 2026

The fact that the last three of his top-10 victories had all come against Fritz didn’t exactly portend a star turn against Alcaraz – who entered Tuesday’s match with a 3-0 record against Shelton.

— The Guardian, 09 Sep 2026

Mass layoffs at the Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) portend a future with more infectious disease outbreaks, chronic conditions, and a widening gulf in health between the most affluent and vulnerable, experts told the Guardian.

— The Guardian, 09 Apr 2025

The sudden rise in oil prices portended a looming recession.

— Example sentence

The darkening sky portended an approaching storm.

— Example sentence

SYNONYMS

foreshadow, herald, presage, augur, signal

ANTONYMS

refute, contradict